

Crop & Store Risk Assessments

Combinable Crops & Sugar Beet — Red Tractor self-assessment support · Prepared 24 September 2026

This covers three separate audit-day requirements in one document. All items confirmed by James 28 September 2026, except the specific compaction management routine (see Section 3).

1. Growing Crop Risk Assessment

Purpose: identify risks to food safety, the environment and crop quality arising from growing crops at Upper Assendon Farm, and the controls in place to manage them.

Risk area	Hazard	Control in place	Status
Contamination from adjoining land/roads	Spray drift, dust, litter blown onto crops	Buffer strips maintained on field margins (SFI/CS arable margins — see Farm Map); hedgerows managed per BE3	In place
Water/soil contamination	No watercourses or ditches on the farm (confirmed 24 Sep 2026)	No water-proximity exclusion zones apply on this holding	Confirmed — low risk
Pest/disease/weed risk to stored or standing crop	BYDV and WYDV (Yellow Dwarf Virus) affected barley in 2025	Rotation planning; hybrid barley variety Kestrel selected for 2026/27 specifically to help manage BYDV/WYDV pressure; crop walking and agronomist monitoring throughout the season	Confirmed
Contamination from previous land use / neighbouring livestock	Cross-contamination at field boundaries shared with grazing land	Fields grazed by cattle are rotated separately from combinable crop ground; no shared water troughs between arable and stock fields	In place
Machinery/fuel spillage on cropped land	Diesel, oil, hydraulic fluid spills	Spill kit held; refuelling away from watercourses (n/a — none on farm) and away from grain stores	In place
High-risk areas identified on the farm map	Many fields on the holding are steep; standard practice is to cultivate and drill across the banks (contour), with minimal cultivation, to manage erosion risk	See Farm Map — Working Reference for building/field layout	Confirmed

2. Grain Store Risk Assessment

Purpose: identify risks to stored grain quality and safety (contamination, pest ingress, spoilage, structural/fire risk) and the controls in place.

Risk area	Hazard	Control in place / needed	Status
Vermin ingress	Rodents/birds contaminating stored	Vermin control programme in place (see	In place — monthly

	grain	Vermin Control Annual Site Survey) — monthly visits by Advanced Pest Control Services (external contractor)	
Moisture/heating (spoilage, mycotoxins)	Damp grain, hot spots, mould/mycotoxin development	Underfloor cooling/drying fan in the corn store; James checks the corn stores fortnightly — see Grain Storage Strategy & Records Pack	In place — fortnightly checks
Chemical contamination	Residues from previous store use, spray drift, rodenticide	Store cleaned between harvests (see Grain Store Cleaning Record); chemicals stored separately in the pesticide store	In place
Structural/fire risk	Building condition, electrics, dust	Building maintained (covered under general Housing & Facilities checklist); electrical and fire safety checks carried out annually	In place — annual checks
Cross-contamination between grain lots/varieties	Mixing varieties or treated/untreated seed	Store cleaned and store records kept identifying variety in store (Traceability checklist)	In place
Access control	Unauthorised access, visitor contamination risk	Farm generally not open to the public; visitor log book to be introduced (see outstanding action)	Linked to visitor log book action

3. Soil Management Plan

This sits alongside the farm's Nutrient Management Plan (which covers nutrient applications) and addresses soil structure, organic matter and erosion risk.

- Soil testing: carried out within the last 5 years across the farm (see Certificates — soil analysis reports on file).
- Soil organic matter: reviewed annually as part of the SFI1 SAM1 action — latest results (SOYL/Frontier Soil Life report, sampled 7 March 2025, Dumas method): Lewknor East 4.4%, Lewknor North 5.0%, Lewknor South 5.0%, Lewknor West 5.4% — all rated Good.
- Cultivation approach: minimal cultivation used across the farm.
- Erosion and run-off risk: no watercourses on the farm (confirmed 24 Sep 2026), so run-off to water is not a live risk on this holding; many fields on the holding are steep, so standard practice farm-wide is to cultivate and drill across the banks (contour cultivation), combined with minimal cultivation, to manage soil loss/structure risk.
- Organic matter maintenance: FYM/organic manure applications recorded (see Fertiliser checklist); cover cropping under SFI3 SOH3 across ~57ha (Silo Field, Steins Park, Fawley Bottom, 20 Acres, Hangings Hill and one further parcel) also supports soil structure.
- Compaction management: reduced by the minimal cultivation approach used across the farm; [CONFIRM specific routine — e.g. avoiding travel on wet ground, tyre pressure management, subsoiling where needed].

Updated 28 September 2026 with James's input on pest pressure, cultivation approach, vermin control frequency, corn store monitoring and fire/electrical safety checks. Still outstanding: the specific compaction management routine (soil organic matter results now confirmed above).